

Rolling Thunder

Created by Undeadender and Essayons361

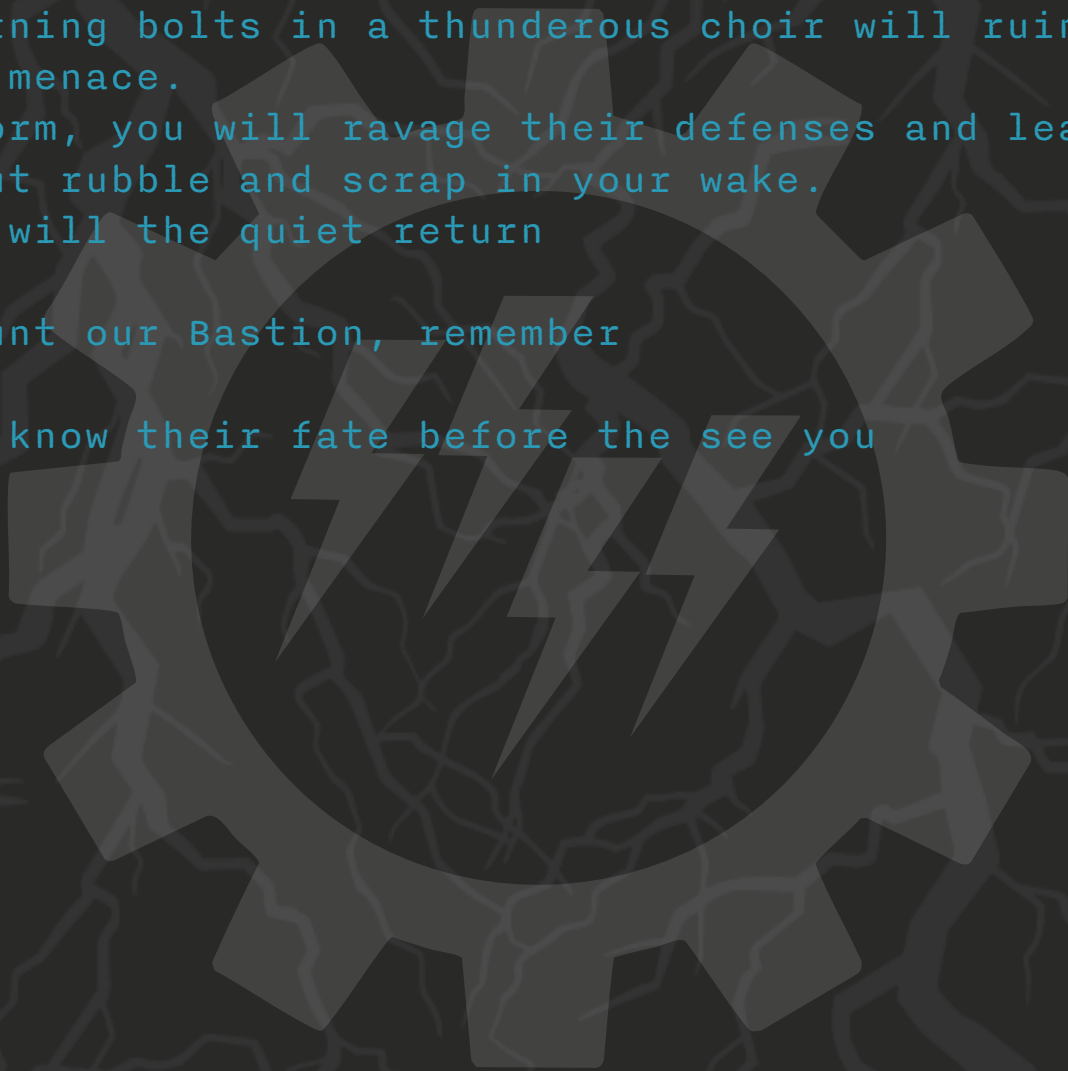
You may not be quiet, but you need not be. The Automations cannot prepare for you.

Four lightning bolts in a thunderous choir will ruin the Automaton menace.

Like a storm, you will ravage their defenses and leave nothing but rubble and scrap in your wake. Only then will the quiet return

As you mount our Bastion, remember

They will know their fate before they see you





Rolling Thunder



General Info

Why did we make this? The **Bastion** by itself is very vulnerable, and each of these roles allows the **Bastion** to reach its full potential as an objective clearing machine.

Nothing in this guide is definitive; you can make your own loadout choices, but these are what we found most effective.

Boosters



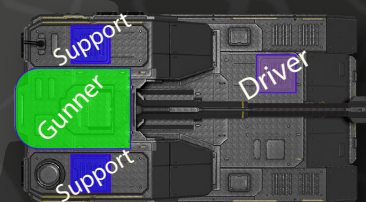
Each role compliments each other. The **Heavy and Light Support** can quickly clear objectives, allowing **Driver and Gunner** to support from the **Bastion**.

For the most part, **Heavy and Light Support** should stay together, with **Driver and Gunner** sticking together.

Driver should be the most experienced as they make the most decisions. Both **Heavy and Gunner** should be able to drive the **Bastion** if needed, and **Heavy** should also be able man the cannon if necessary.

The Bastion

With 8k health, the **Bastion** can take a beating and, with great offensive power at the cost of speed, a **120mm HV cannon** with 31 rounds and a **coaxial HMG** with 2k rounds, the **Bastion** is the pillar upon which this strategy is built. The **Bastion** is also completely enclosed, protecting passengers from any explosions or incoming fire. **To the Right is the seating chart.**



The order that team members drop the **Bastion** is **Light Support, Driver**, then **Gunner**. If a member higher on the list has their **Bastion**, they always drop it first, i.e., even if **Gunner** has not dropped a Bastion, **Light Support** will drop theirs if it is off cooldown when one is needed.

The **Bastion** has simple controls, but things of note are that the handbrake brings the **Bastion** to a halt quickly from any speed. The **Bastion** can turn without moving forward or backward, simply by holding left or right while stationary. The **Bastion** can easily drive over most obstacles. Due to this, keeping to the center of roads is recommended.

For **Heavy and Light Support**, it is best to mount by climbing the sides near the ladder (**pictured right**), to avoid running in the way of **Gunner**. **Heavy and Light Support** can also help **Driver** navigate streets by giving directions.





Actions on Objectives



Outposts and Command Bunkers

Driver positions the **Bastion** so **Gunner** can fire on the target. While the **Light** and **Heavy** support pull security and defend the **Bastion** (keeping an eye out for high-priority targets such as Factory Striders(dog), Rocket Devistators, Reinforced Scout Striders, and machine gun nests). If an outpost is difficult to maneuver around a laser or barrage, preferably from **Light** or **Heavy** can eliminate or heavily damage the outpost. **Heavy Support** should call down a shield relay on the Command Bunkers, allowing the **Bastion** to stay safe from the bunker's defenses.

Stratagem Jammer and Compromise Automaton Defenses

The team dismounts and pushes the objective with the **Light** support in the front, and the **Heavy** takes out any hulks. **Driver** and **Gunner** push to the terminal to complete the objective. Be aware that the **Bastion** will most likely be destroyed. Make sure the area is clear before calling in a new **Bastion**.

Gunship fabricator and Detector Tower

Light and **Heavy** get out and throw down a Hellbomb or a 500 kg(only for the Detector Tower if it is available) next to the tower/fabricator, then activate Hellbomb and remount the **Bastion**. **Light** can also throw a 500 kg from the **Bastion**; this is preferred but not always possible.

Destroy Dropships, Bio-Processors, and Mortar Emplacements

Light and **Driver** get out and move onto the objective. **Driver** uses **C4** to eliminate the destruction targets. **Gunner** and **Heavy** defend the **Bastion** (**Heavy** can drop a shield relay if necessary), watch out for drops, and if necessary, **Gunner** repositions the **Bastion**.

Transit

Heavy and **light** support defend sides and rear.

The whole team dismounts only when **Driver** says, "DISMOUNT".

If you see an enemy trying to use a flare, target them to prevent bot drops.

Priorities of objectives in order(Stratagem Jammer, Detector Tower, Mortar Emplacement, Compromise Automaton Defenses, Gunship Factory, other).

When a drop happens, **Heavy** should call down a sentry, and **Driver** moves to a safe area and accesses. If there is a Factory Strider make sure to eliminate it even if the position is not valuable. If the drop does not contain a factory strider or after it is killed **Driver** decides on whether the position needs to be fought over (i.e., has a high value objective), if yes **Supports** throw barrages and eagles. If the team is dismounted **Driver** throws a barrage regardless, the team fortifies the objective. If the Team is low on supplies or dismounted, in a safe area, call in the Super Destroyer resupply to save the supply packs.



Driver



Weapons and Armor

Your primary is up to personal choice as **Driver**, if not using a weapon from the explosive category, bring a grenade pistol. For your grenade, you should bring the G/SH-39 Shield, as it allows you to stay safe on terminals or give a teammate a better fortified position.

Your armor should be unflinching; this is due to the scanner pings allowing you to make better decisions about your approach to objectives. Scout can also be used if unflinching is not owned. Your armor can be on the lighter side, as you mostly live in the **Bastion**, and speed back to the **Bastion** is important.

Stratagems

Bastion - You will be the Second to drop a **Bastion**. As **Driver** it is important to keep the **Bastion** safe. The **Bastion** has a lot of health, but can still be destroyed quickly if left without cover or by staying still for too long.

C4 Pack - With the **C4 Pack**, destruction objectives can be eliminated quickly, allowing the team to stay mobile. The **C4 Pack** can also be used as an anti-heavy unit tool when needed. If you are low on **C4 Light** can top you up in a pinch.

120/380/Walking Barrage - If an outpost is difficult to navigate, a barrage can help reduce the time needed to eliminate the larger outposts. Barrages are also useful in softening bot drops, preferably when the team is dismounted.

Orbital Laser/Eagle 500kg Bomb - Similar to the Barrages, these can soften outposts and bot drops.

Role Responsibilities

As **Driver** you are the leader of the team; you decide what and how the team engages targets and objectives. When directing **Gunner** to fire upon a target, ping it so that your commands are clearer. Also, be aware that light poles mess with **Gunner's** aim.

Listen to **Gunner** if the **Bastion** needs to be turned to fire upon a target.

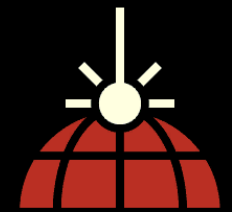
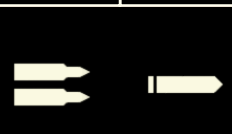
In general, enemy target priority is Factory Striders(dog), unscrambled turrets, Tanks, War Striders, Hulks, then all others.

Be sure to callout, **"Hold Fire"**, when mounting or dismounting (so **Gunner** doesn't shoot you).

Direct **Heavy** to call down a shield relay or sentry when necessary; when holding an area or after a bot drop is called.

Call out, "DISMOUNT", when the entire team is to exit the Bastion.

Call for a new **Bastion** if the current one is heavily damaged(usually, when it is smoking is a good time)





Weapons and Armor

For your primary, use the Trident for unlimited ammo and crowd control. The second choice is the Plasma Punisher for destructive power and good ammo economy. If you don't have either, use an automatic weapon (SMG, AR, Sythe, or Sickles). Bring a Stim pistol to heal any small damage that the team takes, saving resupplies. Bring gas grenades for crowd control, allowing control of chokepoints when defending the tank.

Your armor should be medium with extra padding or fortified to increase your survivability and still allow mobility.

Stratagems

Bastion - You will be the last to drop a **Bastion**. As your loadout is the most reliant on the **Bastion**, it is your responsibility to ensure the **Bastion** is safe when parked.

Recoilless Rifle - This is for **Heavy Support**.

Grenade Launcher - Your first **GL** should go to **Light Support**, and once the **GL** is off cooldown, call another one to increase your lethality if dismounted, allowing you to defend the **Bastion** more effectively.

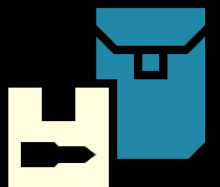
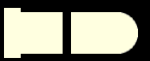
Supply Pack - Your first pack should go to **Light Support**, and once the pack is off cooldown, call another one to increase your sustainability if dismounted. **Light** may ask to switch packs if theirs is low.

Role Responsibilities

Your main responsibility is to fire upon the targets ahead of the **Bastion**, the ones marked by **Driver** or **Light** first. If the **Bastion** is parked, then you will keep it safe. This does not mean hold it at all cost just try your best. When defending the **Bastion**, it can sometimes be helpful to move the **Bastion**.

Exit the **Bastion** only when **Driver** says, "**DISMOUNT**", to avoid being run over. While the main cannon eliminates most targets, don't be afraid to use the coaxial machine gun. While reloading, use the coaxial machine gun to eliminate targets (it can kill hulks by shooting its eye).

In general, enemy target priority is **Factory Striders(dog)**, **unscrambled turrets**, **Tanks**, **War Striders**, **Hulks**, then all others.





Heavy Support



Weapons and Armor

The Eruptor or Explosive Crossbow are the best primary options, as they allow you to still clear groups effectively; secondary is down to personal choice.

Your armor should be Fortified or Extra Padding to increase survivability. You can be on the heavier side, but medium is best. Grenades should be for crowd clearing; frags, dynamite, or impacts are good.

Stratagems

Shield Generator Relay - This helps keep the **Bastion** safe when stationary.

Gatling/Machine Gun Sentry - If holding a position or retreating from a drop, the sentry can assist in eliminating smaller targets.

Rocket Sentry - If holding a position or retreating from a drop, the sentry can reduce the amount of **Recoilless** rockets that are used.

120/380/Walking Barrage - Barrages are also useful in softening bot drops, and can also be used against objectives if needed.

Support Weapon and Backpack

Recoilless Rifle - **Gunner** will drop this for you. As **Heavy Support**, you must ensure that heavy units that flank the **Bastion** are eliminated. **Driver** may also call for you to destroy other targets. If you are low on rounds, **Light** can top you up in a pinch.

Role Responsibilities

Your main responsibility is to ensure the flanks of the tanks remain free of heavy units.

In general, enemy target priority is Factory Striders(dog), unscrambled turrets, War Striders, Tanks, Hulks, Rocket Devistators and Reinforced Scout Striders, machine gun nests, then all others.

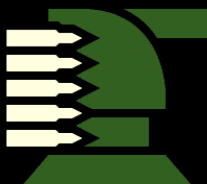
Ping high-priority targets (Factory Striders(dog), unscrambled turrets, and Fabricators) in front of the **Bastion** to help **Gunner** see what needs to be shot.

Be sure to say, "**CROSSING OVER**", when firing over the **Bastion** to allow **Light** to get out of your line of fire. In general, only fire the **Recoilless Rifle** this way.

If in an outpost **Driver** may ask you to eliminate a fabricator to speed up the process.

If a mortar emplacement is in the area, try to peek out of the tank in short bursts to avoid being killed by a mortar round hitting the top of the **Bastion**.

When the team is being chased by many enemies, throw down a sentry to draw fire (avoid doubling up on sentries).



Support Weapon





Light Support



Weapons and Armor

For your primary, use the Trident for unlimited ammo and crowd control. Alternatives are the Plasma Punisher or Automatic weapons (SMG, AR, Sythe, or Sickles). You should switch to your primary for closer targets so that you don't damage the tank with your **GL**. Bring a Stim pistol to heal any small damage that the team takes. Take thermite grenades to eliminate heavy units when they are close.

For your armor, bring medium servo-assisted to allow you to throw your stratigems further. As an alternative, you can use desert stormer for a slightly lesser throwing range and resistance to elemental damage (better choice for Incineration Corps).

Stratagems

Bastion - You will be the First to drop a **Bastion**.

Orbital Laser - If an outpost is difficult to navigate, a laser can help reduce the time needed to eliminate the larger outposts

Eagle 500kg Bomb - Can be thrown behind the **Bastion** or into objectives to clear heavy units. As the 500 kg greatly reduces the time to eliminate objectives like the Detector Tower, ensure you have at least one as much as possible.

Eagle Strafing Run - The strafe can be used to soften objectives or cover a retreat. Don't be afraid to use the strafe freely; you have five. Saving one can be useful if you have the advanced crew training Super Destroyer upgrade to reduce the cooldown of your rearm

Support Weapon and Backpack

Grenade Launcher - **Gunner** will drop this for you. Use the **GL** freely to eliminate enemies that attack the **Bastion**.

Supply Pack - **Gunner** will also drop this for you. This is to keep you and the team loaded. If you need to resupply while in the **Bastion**, tell **Driver** to stop and exit the vehicle to quickly resupply and remount. If your pack is running low, you can switch with **Gunner** as they use theirs less.

Role Responsibilities

Your main responsibility is to ensure the flanks of the tanks remain free of light units. **In general, enemy target priority is Rocket Devistators and Reinforced Scout Striders, machine gun nests, Devistators, Troopers, Hulks, then all others.** Be sure to say, "**CROSSING OVER**", when firing over the tank to allow **Heavy** to get out of your line of fire. Avoid doing this. You can also heal **Heavy** with your Stim pistol when necessary.

If in an outpost **Driver** may ask you to eliminate a fabricator to speed up the process.

If a mortar emplacement is in the area, try to peek out of the tank in short bursts to avoid being killed by a mortar round hitting the top of the Bastion.



Support Weapon

